Project HODOR Release 2.0.0 Product Brief and Roadmap

Product brief for the next production release of Ank Kumar's public digital gateway

Product	Project HODOR
Release	2.0.0
Requirement freeze	14 October 2026, 11:59 PM IST
Production approval	Ank Kumar only

Release Objective

Release 2.0.0 extends HODOR from a successful digital gateway into a more engaging and useful visitor experience.
Release 1.0.3 achieved its primary goals:

1. ank-kumar.github.io is live.
2. The site has been indexed by Google.
3. Total infrastructure cost, including Capex and Opex, is USD 0.

Release 2.0.0 focuses on improving user experience, increasing engagement, and giving visitors useful free content that encourages them to explore, learn, stay, return, and reuse the public resources efficiently.

Release 2.0.0 Focus Areas

1. Improve user experience and engagement.
2. Strengthen the user journey with a clear initial hook and useful free content.
3. Commission a Technology page for article publishing.
4. Refactor code and support a more dynamic user interface.
5. Repurpose the local development instance to mirror Production Release 1.0.3.
6. Upload selected video and photo assets to archive.org and Wikimedia on a best effort basis.
7. Introduce topic and region relationships with drill-down paths for photos and videos.

Product Purpose

HODOR exists to present the public professional and creative world of Ank Kumar in one credible, useful, and freely accessible online platform.

The site should help visitors quickly understand:

- who Ank Kumar is
- what he builds
- what he contributes publicly
- where his work has appeared
- why the work is credible
- what useful content visitors can explore and use for free
- where visitors may ask questions or interact in future, if that feature is approved

The product should not feel like a static resume. It should feel like a living gateway into an organically evolving body of work.

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Release Theme

The theme for Release 2.0.0 is: **From discovery to destination.**
The site has already been discovered online. Now it must reward every visit.

Visitor Engagement Strategy

Release 2.0.0 should improve staying time through two layers.

Initial Hook:

The first screen must immediately give the visitor a reason to care.

The hook should combine:

- a clear identity statement
- high signal proof points
- links to the strongest areas of work
- visible access to photo and video contribution showcases
- a clear sense that the site contains useful material, not only self-description

Within a few seconds, the visitor should understand that this is a real person with real output, public contributions, and useful material worth exploring.

Useful Free Content:

After the hook, the site should provide useful content at no cost, in meaningful volume, across a broad range of topics. The content should be immediately available for correct reuse by visitors.

Examples include:

- open licence photo contribution showcase
- video contribution showcase
- curated Wikimedia and Commons work
- verified publication and reuse examples
- technical projects and architecture work
- AI, automation, and reliability engineering artifacts
- selected learning resources or explainers
- visual stories from travel, photography, aviation, architecture, and technology

The free value is important. The site should make the visitor feel that they received something useful by spending time there. If nothing else, they should leave with knowledge and a better idea of the world through visual cues.

My point of view: **Genuine curiosity with no ROI intent.**

Success Criteria

Release 2.0.0 should be considered successful if it improves the site as a destination without risking the stability or performance of the current live gateway.

Primary success criteria:

1. The site improves as a useful destination while preserving stability and performance.
   KPI sources include site visit statistics and Google Search Console.
2. The video catalogue is live with efficient page performance.
3. At least 500 video clips are uploaded to archive.org or Wikimedia.

Operational success will be measured by:

- continued indexing and search visibility
- no regression in ranking for "Ank Kumar"

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- working navigation across all three live properties
- improved clarity of the homepage hook
- richer paths into photo and video contribution content
- no broken public links
- valid structured data were used
- clean GitHub Pages deployment
- explicit production approval by Ank Kumar before release

Release 2.0.0 Scope

The current Release 2.0.0 candidate scope includes:

- Improve the main gateway (landing page) experience.
- Strengthen cross-linking between the main site, photo contributions, and video contributions.
- Move reef reel media off GitHub to Internet Archive while keeping GitHub as the public index.
- Apply library inventory with the correct creation date reconciliation rule.
- Add trip-level tagging.
- Add UAE, Oman, and Slovakia chips to the photo showcase.
- Run build_topics.py before build_showcase.py.
- Upload only encyclopaedically useful media subsets to Wiki Commons.
- Refactor site code where it improves maintainability without changing the core product promise.

Out of Scope Unless Explicitly Approved

The following are not part of Release 2.0.0 unless approved separately:

- major redesign
- ranking-risky SEO rewrites
- unverified impact claims
- bulk upload of media without review
- casual publication of uncommitted image-reuse-tracker work
- changes that require new paid infrastructure
- changes that expose private data, credentials, or large original media files

Release 3.0.0 Roadmap Note

Release 3.0.0 is tentatively planned for November 2026.

The current abstract direction is to enhance knowledge and its presentation on the website. This idea is intentionally not locked yet. It will evolve after Release 2.0.0 stabilizes the site as a useful destination.

Potential Release 3.0.0 themes may include:

- deeper knowledge experiences
- richer explanatory content
- structured learning paths
- searchable knowledge artifacts
- more useful public resources built from Ank Kumar's work and contributions
- an active CI/CD pipeline
- Introduction of Agentic Solution if a use case warrants it.

Release 3.0.0 should remain flexible until the Release 2.0.0 outcome is understood and stable.

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HODOR Safety Rule: **"When in doubt, choose quality over velocity."**

HODOR always errs on the side of caution and safety.

- No casual push to production.
- Use a controlled path: development environment build and deploy, test, release package for production, then production deployment.
- No casual add all.
- No unreviewed GitHub Pages deployment.
- No inflated claims.
- No secrets or large media files committed to Git.
- No production release without Ank Kumar's explicit approval.
- Pause when unsure.

Production Approval Rule

Only Ank Kumar approves final deployment to GitHub and the GitHub Actions build path.

No release is production-ready until its thoroughly tested and Ank Kumar(I) approves go-live.

Product Owner Position

HODOR should not chase features for their own sake. It should deepen the user journey.
Release 2.0.0 should make visitors stay longer because the site gives them something useful, interesting, credible, and free.

Version 2.0.0 should preserve the success of Version 1.0.3 while making the live gateway provide genuine value.

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